SURYAKUMAR YADAV, 33

Batsman >

T20s: 68, RUNS: 2,340, SR: 167.74

The image of Suryakumar Yadav leaping in and out of the long-off fence to take a blinder in the last over of the T20 World Cup final has become instantly legendary—an audacious take worthy of someone who habitually takes risks. A 360-degree wielder of the willow, SKY can be a nightmare for bowlers. In T20s, India seemed to be behind the curve until SKY arrived to blast off all limits. Everyone had seen his marauding approach with the bat at astonishing strike rates, but the question was if he could replicate it in an ICC tournament. Before the 2024 T20 World Cup, SKY had appeared in three ICC events but didn't have much to show for all his enormous pedigree. A late bloomer in international cricket, SKY is making up for lost time. In this World Cup, he was India's second-highest run-scorer behind Rohit Sharma and, more importantly, he got those runs under pressure. He will be crucial to India's success in the next few years.



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< KULDEEP YADAV, 29

Spinner

T20s: 40, WICKETS: 69
ECONOMY: 6.77

Kuldeep Yadav's career was at a crossroads, before Rohit Sharma took over the reins of the Indian team. A quality left-arm spinner, it was a mystery that Kuldeep was missing in action. However, he cemented his place in the team with some stellar performances. One of the best wrist-spinners in the world, Kuldeep rarely fails to deliver. There aren't many chinaman bowlers better than Kuldeep, whose control and guile can test the best in the business. Not just in T20Is, the Kanpur boy is now an automatic choice in every format. Team India unleashed Kuldeep in the Caribbean leg of the T20 World Cup, and he appeared in five games, finishing as India's third-highest wicket-taker with 10 scalps. With some seniors like Ravichandran Ashwin and Ravindra Jadeja out of the mix in the shortest format, Kuldeep will lead India's spin attack and will be crucial to India's quest to defend the title in 2026.

RAVI BISHNOI, 23 >

Spinner

T20s: 24, WICKETS: 36, ECONOMY: 7.50

As per his Instagram post, "be yourself and let the world adjust themselves" is Ravi Bishnoi's motto. Pardon the plural, for his baffling googlies and leg-breaks mostly left batters in two minds—and unable to 'adjust themselves'. This has been the script since he notched 17 wickets in the 2020 Under-19 World Cup to finish on top and when he picked up 16 wickets as Lucknow Super Giants made it to the 2024 IPL playoffs. That was fulfilfment for someone who along with his friends laboured hard to set up a cricket academy in Jodhpur, Rajasthan, and cycled 20 km twice a day to train there. In his maiden T20I, Bishnoi claimed two scalps against the West Indies, helped India win the game and won the Player of the Match. Further proof of his impact in the format: he was named in the ICC Men's T20I Team of the Year in 2023.



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